promoted as being relevant in Myanmar. However, it also indicates that the MaBaTha-backed USDP was not a genuine alternative to the NLD, especially when the whole of Myanmar is aching for change. The NLD victory, despite MaBaTha's rejection, does mean the influences of Buddhist nationalism have dissipated somewhat in Myanmar. Nevertheless, communally focused anti-Muslim sentiment remains important among Buddhists (Walton 2015). The influence of Buddhist nationalism on Myanmar's social and economic life will still need to be factored into any comprehensive analysis of the country's politics for the foreseeable future.

Ethnic nationalism takes many shapes in Myanmar's politics, but most observers have focused primarily on the role of armed organizations (Maung-Thawnghmung 2011). While people who identify as non-Burman ethnic nationalities may not have voted for their ethnic parties, ethnicity remains an important identity aspect and pertinent in other forms, such as cultural, development, or rights organizations.[7] Despite the current weakness of many ethnic parties in the formal assemblies, their aspirations remain relevant to the ethnic minorities (Dolan 2015).

Ultimately the ANP will have very limited opportunities to influence political change and policy institutions in Myanmar. Also, it still faces internal political divisions. In addition to the divide based on support for ethno-nationalism among the Rakhine community, the ANP needs to overcome potential schisms based on personal, positional, and ideological differences. A specific concern is that if the ANP is marginalized in the Rakhine State development agenda despite its strong electoral showing, it could lead to the ANP focusing further on the communal aspects of Rakhine ethno-nationalism, thereby exacerbating existing communal antagonism.